

Formal Truth and Modal Logic

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Introduction

Modal Logic and Sentential Predicates

- ▶ Modal logics as logics of sentential predicates;
 - ▶ Provability logic as logic of the provability predicate;
 - ▶ Modal logic [truth logic] as logic of the truth predicate?

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 - ▶ Provability logic as logic of the provability predicate;
 - ▶ Modal logic [truth logic] as logic of the truth predicate?
- ▶ Modal Logics determine the logical properties of sentential predicates;
 - ▶ Provability logic determines the logical properties of the provability predicates;
 - ▶ Modal logic [truth logic] determines the logical properties of the truth predicate.

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Truth logics?

Are there candidate modal logics that are logics of the (a) truth predicate?

A primer on formal truth

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 - ▶ Weakening of Convention T;
 - ▶ Truth as fixed-point(s) of inductive definitions;
 - ▶ “Semantic theories of truth”

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 - ▶ Truth as fixed-point(s) of inductive definitions;
 - ▶ “Semantic theories of truth”
- ▶ Truth can be axiomatized!
 - ▶ Replace convention T by consistent sets of truth principles;
 - ▶ Approximating Convention T?
 - ▶ “Axiomatic truth theories”

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Remark

Truth theories require some syntax theory, e.g., arithmetics.

Logics of Truth?

What is the logic of truth of a given theory of truth?

- ▶ What are the unrestricted rules and principles of truth?
- ▶ What is the modal logic of a truth theory?
- ▶ Which modal logic captures the logical properties of the truth predicate of a given truth theory?

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Learning from Provability

Similar questions have been explored for the provability predicate:

- ▶ Solovay showed that GL was the logic of the provability predicate of PA.

Provability: Arithmetical Interpretation

Syntax of $\mathcal{L}_\Box$:

$$\varphi ::= p \mid \perp \mid \top \mid \neg\varphi \mid \varphi \wedge \varphi \mid \Box\varphi$$

where $p \in \text{At}$.

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Realization

A function $* : \text{At} \rightarrow \text{Sent}_{\mathcal{L}_{\text{PA}}}$ is called a realization.

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Arithmetical Interpretation

A realization $*$ induces an arithmetical interpretation

$H^* : \mathcal{L}_{\Box} \rightarrow \text{Sent}_{\mathcal{L}_{\text{PA}}}$:

$$H^*(\varphi) := \begin{cases} \varphi^*, & \text{if } \varphi \in \text{At}; \\ 0 = 1, & \text{if } \varphi \doteq \perp; \\ 0 = 0, & \text{if } \varphi \doteq \top; \\ \neg H^*(\psi), & \text{if } \varphi \doteq \neg\psi; \\ H^*(\psi) \wedge H^*(\chi), & \text{if } \varphi \doteq \psi \wedge \chi; \\ \text{Pr}_{\text{PA}}(\ulcorner H^*(\psi) \urcorner), & \text{if } \varphi \doteq \Box\psi. \end{cases}$$

Provability: Solovay's Completeness Result

Theorem (Solovay)

For all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_\square$

$$\text{GL} \vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \forall * (\text{PA} \vdash H^*(\varphi))$$

$$\text{GLS} \vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \forall * (\mathbb{N} \models H^*(\varphi))$$

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- Are there similar results for theories of truth?

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- ▶ Axiomatic theories of truth: isn't it trivial?
 - ▶ Löb's theorem

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 - ▶ T-sentences

Truth Interpretation

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A function $* : \text{At} \rightarrow \text{Sent}_{\mathcal{L}_T}$ is called a truth-realization.

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A realization $*$ induces a truth interpretation $H^* : \mathcal{L}_{\Box} \rightarrow \text{Sent}_{\mathcal{L}_T}$:

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Towards Truth-theoretic Completeness

Let Σ be a truth theory. Then for all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_\square$

$$? \vdash \varphi \text{ iff } \forall * (\Sigma \vdash H^*(\varphi)).$$

Aim of talk

Determine the modal logics of Kripkean truth theories;

- Kripke-Feferman Truth

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Determine the modal logics of Kripkean truth theories;

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-
- ▶ The results are joint work with Carlo Nicolai (Nicolai and Stern, 2021).
 - ▶ Philosophical discussion in Stern (2025)

Outline

Introduction

Kripkean Truth

Modal Logics and Semantics

Truth-theoretic Completeness

Refutation Proofs

Kripkean Truth

Axiomatic Truth: The Theory Kripke-Feferman

KF

KF extends PAT with the axioms:

$$(KF1) \quad \forall s \forall t (Ts \doteq t \leftrightarrow s^\circ = t^\circ)$$

$$(KF2) \quad \forall s \forall t (Ts \neq t \leftrightarrow s^\circ \neq t^\circ)$$

$$(KF3) \quad \forall x (Sent(x) \rightarrow (T \neg \neg x \leftrightarrow Tx))$$

$$(KF4) \quad \forall x, y (Sent(x \wedge y) \rightarrow (Tx \wedge Ty \leftrightarrow T(x \wedge y)))$$

$$(KF5) \quad \forall x, y (Sent(x \wedge y) \rightarrow (T \neg x \vee T \neg y \leftrightarrow T \neg (x \wedge y)))$$

$$(KF6) \quad \forall v \forall x (Sent(\forall vx) \rightarrow (\forall t Tx(t/v) \leftrightarrow T \forall vx))$$

$$(KF7) \quad \forall v \forall x (Sent(\forall vx) \rightarrow (\exists t T \neg x(t/v) \leftrightarrow T \neg \forall vx))$$

$$(KF8) \quad \forall t (Tt^\circ \leftrightarrow T \neg T t)$$

$$(KF9) \quad \forall t (T \neg t^\circ \vee \neg Sent(t^\circ) \leftrightarrow T \neg T t)$$

Axiomatic Truth: The Theory Kripke-Feferman

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$$(KF3) \quad \forall x (\text{Sent}(x) \rightarrow (T \neg \neg x \leftrightarrow Tx))$$

$$(KF4) \quad \forall x, y (\text{Sent}(x \frown y) \rightarrow (Tx \wedge Ty \leftrightarrow T(x \frown y)))$$

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Kripke's semantic theory: Fixed-point Semantics

- ▶ Let e be an evaluation scheme. Then e gives rise to a jump operation $\mathcal{J}_e : \mathcal{P}(\omega) \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(\omega)$ with

$$\mathcal{J}_e(X) = \{ \# \phi : (\mathbb{N}, X) \models_e \phi \}$$

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- ▶ Fixed points of $\mathcal{J}_{\text{FDE}}$ are exactly the models of KF over $\mathbb{N}$.

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$$\mathcal{J}_e(S) = S.$$

- ▶ Fixed points of $\mathcal{J}_{\text{FDE}}$ are exactly the models of KF over $\mathbb{N}$.
 - K3 Consistent fixed points—KF+CN
 - LP Complete fixed points—KF+CM

A Solovay-Style Result for Kripke-Feferman?

The Question

$$? \vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \forall * (KF \vdash H^*(\varphi))$$

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An Idea

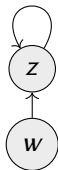
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- ▶ Inner logic is subclassical, i.e., FDE.

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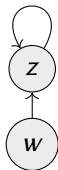
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- ▶ The classical world w sees an “idiosyncratic” subclassical world z .

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An Idea



- ▶ Classical logic but..
- ▶ Inner logic is subclassical, i.e., FDE.
- ▶ The classical world w sees an “idiosyncratic” subclassical world z .
- ▶ The logic of w is the modal logic of KF.

Modal Logics and Semantics

Subclassical Logics

FDE

$$\text{(REF)} \quad \frac{\Gamma, \varphi \Rightarrow \varphi, \Delta}{\text{for } \varphi \text{ a literal}}$$

$$(\perp) \quad \Gamma, \perp \Rightarrow \Delta$$

$$\text{(CUT)} \quad \frac{\Gamma \Rightarrow \varphi, \Delta \quad \Gamma, \varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}{\Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta}$$

$$(\top) \quad \Gamma \Rightarrow \top, \Delta$$

$$\text{(dn-l)} \quad \frac{\Gamma \Rightarrow \varphi, \Delta}{\Gamma \Rightarrow \neg\neg\varphi, \Delta}$$

$$\text{(dn-r)} \quad \frac{\Gamma, \varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}{\Gamma, \neg\neg\varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}$$

$$(\wedge l) \quad \frac{\Gamma, \varphi, \psi \Rightarrow \Delta}{\Gamma, \varphi \wedge \psi \Rightarrow \Delta}$$

$$(\wedge r) \quad \frac{\Gamma \Rightarrow \varphi, \Delta \quad \Gamma \Rightarrow \psi, \Delta}{\Gamma \Rightarrow \varphi \wedge \psi, \Delta}$$

$$(\neg\wedge r) \quad \frac{\Gamma, \neg\varphi \Rightarrow \Delta \quad \Gamma, \neg\psi \Rightarrow \Delta}{\Gamma, \neg(\varphi \wedge \psi) \Rightarrow \Delta}$$

$$(\neg\wedge r) \quad \frac{\Gamma \Rightarrow \neg\varphi, \neg\psi, \Delta}{\Gamma \Rightarrow \neg(\varphi \wedge \psi), \Delta}$$

Subclassical Logics

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Subclassical Logics

LP

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The Truth Logic FDE $_{\Box}$

The truth logic of the subclassical worlds

Let $\mathcal{S} \in \{\text{FDE}, \text{K3}, \text{LP}\}$. Then $\mathcal{S}_{\Box}$ is obtained by adding the following rules to $\mathcal{S}$:

$$(\Box\text{L}) \quad \frac{\Gamma, \varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}{\Gamma, \Box\varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}$$

$$(\Box\text{R}) \quad \frac{\Gamma \Rightarrow \varphi, \Delta}{\Gamma \Rightarrow \Box\varphi, \Delta}$$

$$(\neg\Box\text{L}) \quad \frac{\Gamma, \neg\varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}{\Gamma, \neg\Box\varphi \Rightarrow \Delta}$$

$$(\neg\Box\text{R}) \quad \frac{\Gamma \Rightarrow \neg\varphi, \Delta}{\Gamma \Rightarrow \neg\Box\varphi, \Delta}$$

Non-Congruent Modal Logic

The logic of the classical worlds

BM extends propositional logic by

$(\top)$	$\Box \top$
$(\perp)$	$\neg \Box \perp$
$(\neg)$	$\Box \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \neg \varphi$
$(\wedge 1)$	$\Box(\varphi \wedge \psi) \leftrightarrow \Box \varphi \wedge \Box \psi$
$(\wedge 2)$	$\Box \neg(\varphi \wedge \psi) \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \varphi \vee \Box \neg \psi$
$(\Box 1)$	$\Box \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \Box \varphi$
$(\Box 2)$	$\Box \neg \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \Box \varphi$
(FV)	$\Box \varphi \wedge \neg \Box \neg \varphi \rightarrow \varphi$

Non-Congruent Modal Logic

The logic of the classical worlds

M^n extends propositional logic by

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$$(\perp) \quad \neg \Box \perp$$

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$$(\wedge 2) \quad \Box \neg(\varphi \wedge \psi) \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \varphi \vee \Box \neg \psi$$

$$(\Box 1) \quad \Box \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \Box \varphi$$

$$(\Box 2) \quad \Box \neg \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \Box \varphi$$

$$(FV) \quad \Box \varphi \wedge \neg \Box \neg \varphi \rightarrow \varphi$$

$$(D) \quad \Box \neg \varphi \rightarrow \neg \Box \varphi$$

Non-Congruent Modal Logic

The logic of the classical worlds

M^b extends propositional logic by

$$(\top) \quad \Box \top$$

$$(\perp) \quad \neg \Box \perp$$

$$(\neg) \quad \Box \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \neg \varphi$$

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$$(\Box 2) \quad \Box \neg \varphi \leftrightarrow \Box \neg \Box \varphi$$

$$(FV) \quad \Box \varphi \wedge \neg \Box \neg \varphi \rightarrow \varphi$$

$$(D_c) \quad \neg \Box \varphi \rightarrow \Box \neg \varphi$$

The Connection

- ▶ The subclassical truth logic is the **inner** logic of the non-congruent modal logic.

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Connecting Lemma

Let Γ, Δ be finite sets of formulas of $\mathcal{L}_\square$. Then

$$\text{If } \text{FDE}_\square \vdash \Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta, \text{ then } \text{BM} \vdash \bigwedge \square \Gamma \rightarrow \bigvee \square \Delta$$

This also holds for the pairs $(\text{K3}_\square, \text{M}^n)$ and $(\text{LP}_\square, \text{M}^b)$.

Semantics: Mixed Idiosyncratic Frames

Let W, Z be disjoint, nonempty sets and $R \subseteq (W \cup Z) \times Z$.
 $F = \langle W, Z, R \rangle$ is called a **mixed frame**. F is called a **mixed idiosyncratic frame** iff

(FUNCTIONALITY) $\forall w \in W \exists! v \in Z (wRv)$

(IDIOSYNCRACY) $\forall w, v \in Z (wRv \leftrightarrow w = v)$

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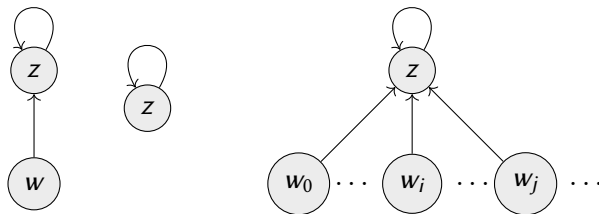


Figure: Idiosyncratic frame configurations

Mixed Models—FDE

- ▶ **Mixed Valuation.** $V : \text{At} \times W \cup Z \rightarrow \{0, n, b, 1\}$ with $V_w(p) \in \{0, 1\}$ for all $p \in \text{At}$ and $w \in W$.

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Let $z \in Z$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{M}, z \Vdash \Box\varphi &\Leftrightarrow \forall v \in Z (zRv \Rightarrow \mathcal{M}, v \Vdash \varphi); \\ \mathcal{M}, z \Vdash \neg\Box\varphi &\Leftrightarrow \exists v \in Z (zRv \ \& \ \mathcal{M}, v \Vdash \neg\varphi).\end{aligned}$$

Truth in Mixed Models and Consequence—FDE

- ▶ $\mathcal{M} \Vdash_{\text{cl}} \varphi$ iff $\forall w \in W(\mathcal{M}, w \Vdash \varphi)$
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- ▶ $F \Vdash_{\text{cl}}^+ \varphi$ iff $\mathcal{M} \Vdash_{\text{cl}} \varphi$ for all $\mathcal{M}$ based on a **faithful valuation**.
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Consequence

Let Γ, Δ be finite sets of formulae. Then

- ▶ $\mathcal{M} \Vdash_{\text{fde}} (\Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta) :\Leftrightarrow \forall z \in Z [\forall \gamma \in \Gamma (\mathcal{M}, z \Vdash \gamma) \Rightarrow \exists \delta \in \Delta (\mathcal{M}, z \Vdash \delta)]$

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Remark on Variant Semantics

- ▶ K3: $V : \text{At} \times W \cup Z \rightarrow \{0, n, 1\}$;
- ▶ LP: $V : \text{At} \times W \cup Z \rightarrow \{0, b, 1\}$.

Completeness

Proposition

Let F be a mixed idiosyncratic frame. Then

$$F \Vdash_{\text{fde}} \Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta \text{ iff } \text{FDE}_{\Box} \vdash \Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta$$

$$F \Vdash_{\text{cl}}^+ \Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta \text{ iff } \text{BM} \vdash \Gamma \Rightarrow \Delta.$$

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Corollary

Let F be a mixed idiosyncratic frame. Then

$$F \Vdash_{\text{cl}}^+ \varphi \Leftrightarrow \text{BM} \vdash \varphi$$

Truth-theoretic Completeness

The Truth-theoretic Completeness of BM

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- ▶ Soundness by induction the length of a proof in BM.
- ▶ Completeness via the contrapositive

$$\text{BM} \not\vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \exists * (\text{KF} \not\vdash H^*(\varphi)).$$

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- ▶ $(\mathbb{N}, S^\dagger)$ is a model of KF, hence

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On Truth Tellers and the Realization $\circ$

Let $p_1, p_2, \dots$ an enumeration of the propositional variables of $\mathcal{L}_\square$.

$$p_j^\circ := \tau_{2j} \wedge \neg \tau_{2j+1}.$$

where τ_i given by

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Lemma

For any $X, Y \subseteq \omega$ there is a FDE-fixed point S such that

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If $X \cap Y = \emptyset$ [$X \cup Y = \omega$], then we can find a consistent [complete] fixed point.

Finding the Fixed Point $S^\dagger$

Truth Teller Lemma

For any mixed, idiosyncratic, faithful model $\mathcal{M}$ of BM, we can find a FDE-fixed point $S \subset \omega$ such that:

- (i) $\tau_{2j} \in S \Leftrightarrow \mathcal{M}, w \Vdash p_j \text{ or } \mathcal{M}, z \Vdash p_j;$
- (ii) $\neg\tau_{2j} \in S \Leftrightarrow \mathcal{M}, z \Vdash \neg p_j;$
- (iii) $\tau_{2j+1} \in S \Leftrightarrow \mathcal{M}, w \Vdash \neg p_j \text{ \& } \mathcal{M}, z \Vdash p_j;$
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S is called the **image** of $\mathcal{M}$.

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Connecting $\mathcal{M}^\dagger$ and $S^\dagger$

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For all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_\square$

- (i) $\mathcal{M}^\dagger, z \Vdash \varphi \Rightarrow \#H^\circ(\varphi) \in S^\dagger;$
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Proof: Induction on the positive complexity of φ

- ▶ Faithful valuations
- ▶ Base cases by Truth Teller Lemma
- ▶ Modal cases by Auxiliary Lemma

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Let Fix be the set of Kripkean fixed points over $\mathbb{N}$. Then for all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_\square$

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- ▶ The proof can be lifted to the first-order case.

Refutation Proofs

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Consequences of Refutation Proofs

- ▶ M^n (M^b) is the modal logic of **all** consistent extensions of $KF+CN$ ($KF+CM$).
- ▶ M^n is the modal logic of the sentences that are true in the minimal fixed-point model and the theory KF_μ .

Refutation Proofs: Strategy

KF+CN

- ▶ Assume $M^n \not\models \varphi$.
- ▶ By **completeness** there exists a mixed model $\mathcal{M}^\ddagger$ based on a faithful K3-valuation V such that for some $w \in W$

$$\mathcal{M}^\ddagger, w \models \neg\varphi$$

- ▶ Define a **witness-realization $\ddagger$ depending on $\mathcal{M}^\ddagger$** such that

$$\text{KF} + \text{CN} \vdash \neg H^\ddagger(\varphi)$$

- ▶ Hence

$$\exists * (\text{KF} + \text{CN} \not\models H^*(\varphi)).$$

The Witness-Realization

We assume faithful valuations. Let λ be a sentence such that

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- ▶ $\text{KF} + \text{CN} \vdash \lambda$;
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Refutation Proofs: Lemmata

Auxiliary Lemma

For all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_{\square}$

- (i) $\mathcal{M}^{\ddagger}, z \Vdash \varphi \Rightarrow \text{KF} + \text{CN} \vdash \text{T}^{\ulcorner} H^{\circ}(\varphi) \urcorner$;
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For all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_{\square}$

$$\mathcal{M}^{\ddagger}, w \Vdash \varphi \Rightarrow \text{KF} + \text{CN} \vdash H^{\circ}(\varphi).$$

- ▶ Truth-theoretic completeness of M^n without appealing to fixed-point models.
- ▶ Truth-theoretic completeness of M^b can be established by a similar argument.

The Logic of Grounded of Truth

Proposition (Nicolai & S.)

Let $\mathbf{l}$ be the minimal fixed point of $\mathcal{J}_{k3}$. Then for all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_{\square}$

$$M^n \vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \forall * ((\mathbb{N}, \mathbf{l}) \models H^*(\varphi));$$

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The Logic of Grounded of Truth

Proposition (Nicolai & S.)

Let I be the minimal fixed point of $\mathcal{J}_{k3}$. Then for all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}$ $\square$

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Proof of $\Leftarrow$.

Assume $M^n \not\vdash \varphi$. Then $KF + CN \vdash \neg H^\dagger(\varphi)$. But $(\mathbb{N}, I)$ is a model of $KF + CN$ and thus $(\mathbb{N}, I) \not\models H^\dagger(\varphi)$. *qed.*

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- ▶ M^b is the logic of the maximal fixed point.
- ▶ M^n and M^b are a **maximal** truth logics:
 - ▶ No proper extension of M^n or M^b can be the modal logic of a consistent truth theory.

Maximality or approximating Convention T

- ▶ Maximal truth logics **approximate Convention T as far as is consistently possible**;
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 - ▶ there is no consistent truth theory with a truth logic extending a maximal truth logic;
- ▶ Prima facie maximal truth logic are defensible weakenings of Convention T;
 - ▶ Uniqueness lost: rival conceptions of truth;
 - ▶ Philosophically motivated truth-maximal logics.

Maximality and Completeness beyond Kripkean Truth

Proposition (Czarnecki & Zdanowski; Standefer)

For all $\varphi \in \mathcal{L}_\square$

$$\text{KDD}_c \vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \forall * (\text{FS} \vdash H^*(\varphi));$$

$$\text{KDD}_c \vdash \varphi \Leftrightarrow \forall * \exists n \in \omega \forall S \subseteq \omega ((\mathbb{N}, \mathcal{I}_{\text{cl}}^n(S)) \models H^*(\varphi));$$

and KDD_c is a maximal truth logic.

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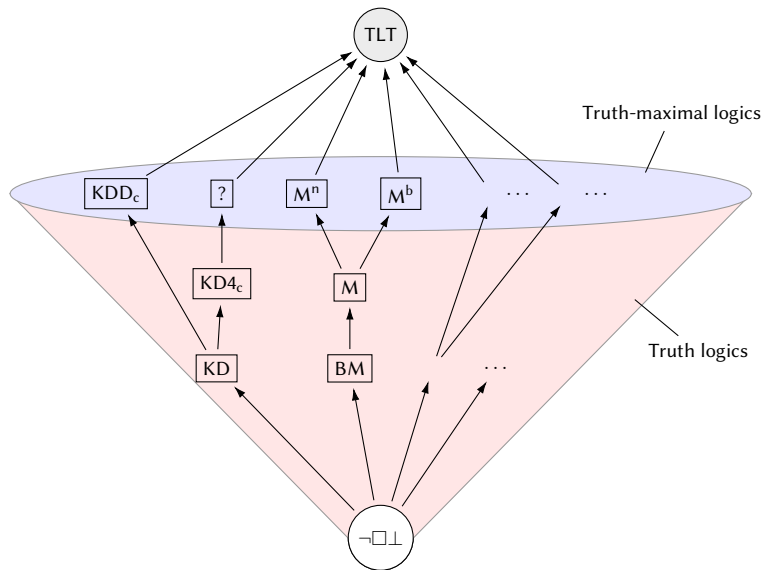
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- ▶ KDD_c is the modal logic of FS and the finite stages of the Revision Theory of Truth;
- ▶ KDD_c is a maximal truth logic;
- ▶ A fully detailed rival account to Kripkean Truth

Logics of Truth



TLT is the modal logic axiomatized by $\Box \varphi \leftrightarrow \varphi$.

Conclusion

Summary

- ▶ Truth-theoretic completeness for the cluster of KF-theories
- ▶ Truth-theoretic completeness for truth in various fixed-point models.
- ▶ Maximality

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Further results

- ▶ First-order logic of truth
- ▶ Weak Kleene and WKF
- ▶ Results for FWK and DT/FKF

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Canonical Model Construction and Existence Lemma

Canonical Model

$\mathcal{M}^C = (\langle W^C, Z^C, R^C \rangle, V^C)$ with

- ▶ W^C is the set of BM-maximal consistent sets.
- ▶ Z^C is the set of $\text{FDE}_{\Box}$ -saturated sets.
- ▶ For $v \in W^C \cup Z^C$, $z \in Z^C$: $vR^Cz \Leftrightarrow \{\varphi : \Box\varphi \in v\} \subseteq z$
- ▶ $V^C(v, p) := \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } p \in v \text{ \& } \neg p \notin v; \\ b, & \text{if } p \in v \text{ \& } \neg p \in v; \\ n & \text{if } p \notin v \text{ \& } \neg p \notin v; \\ 0, & \text{if } p \notin v \text{ \& } \neg p \in v \end{cases}$

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Existence Lemma

Let $w \in W^C$ and $\neg\Box\psi \in w$. Then there exists $z \in Z^C$ such that wR^Cz and $\psi \notin z$.

- ▶ Connecting Lemma!